THE REAL EDGE IS IN PEOPLES' HEADS (Guest: Ahmed Husain)

Podcast: Market huddle

AI Executive Summary

1. Core Thesis: The episode posits that long-term financial success and personal fulfillment require shifting focus from short-term market momentum to "compounding" oneself through cognitive diversity, technological adaptation, and resilient wealth management. By understanding the structural pressures of modern finance (LPs, mark-to-market requirements) and acknowledging exponential changes in technology (AI), investors can build anti-fragile portfolios that prioritize real returns over entertainment and seek opportunities where others see risk.

2. Key Arguments & Data:

3. **Financial Crisis Mechanics:** CDOs (Collateralized Debt Obligations) transformed single-B rated leverage loans into triple-A securities through cash flow rearrangement and over-collateralization, allowing banks to get regulatory capital against assets no one else could buy.
4. **Market Structure:** Current investment vehicles are driven by short-term momentum due to LP pressure (often 2-6 months for redemption), leading to "rolling mini-bubbles" that make staying invested difficult; the game is no longer about moving paper around but bits and exponential tech shifts in Silicon Valley.
5. **Cognitive Diversity & Disagreement:** Investing success relies on having a "beginner's mind" and welcoming "polite disagreement" rather than filter bubbles. The speaker advocates for "Weirdness Premium"—finding assets others are forgetting—rather than fading consensus.
6. **Technology Impact:** AI and cloud tools allow machines to do 90% of the job analysis; productivity is projected to double or triple due to these tools, changing hiring dynamics where young analysts must teach themselves tools or become obsolete.
7. **Investment Philosophy:**
    - **Goal:** Money is a tool for legacy/goals (e.g., "CPI plus 3-6%"), not entertainment.

    - **Portfolio Construction:** Build anti-fragile portfolios across public, private markets, and different sectors to avoid blowing up if one trade fails.
    - **Family Office Dynamics:** Risk appetite differs drastically by generation; first-generation owners are comfortable with risk, while third-generation heirs may be overly fearful.
8. **AI as Bubble vs. Revolution:** The speaker acknowledges a "Wall of Worry" regarding AI (excessive capex/valuation) but invests 40% in AI, arguing that the work is essential to understand value creation despite the bubble narrative.

9. **Personal Compounding:** The greatest asset is the individual's mind and skills; compound oneself by improving 1% daily to become 37x better over a year (vs. just compounding capital).

10. Actionable Takeaways:

11. **Reframe Your Goals:** Ensure money serves specific long-term goals (legacy/wealth) rather than serving as short-term entertainment, potentially adopting inflation-beating targets (e.g., CPI + 6%).
12. **Seek Cognitive Diversity:** Actively expose yourself to different viewpoints and "polite disagreement" within your investment circle to challenge your own blind spots and identify overlooked assets.
13. **Ignore Short-Term Pressure:** Recognize that LP structures force momentum chasing; ignore the "next tick" prediction and focus on long-term themes (e.g., AI, technology) rather than market timing.
14. **Build Anti-Fragile Portfolios:** Do not go "all-in" on one trade (like a bubble); diversify across asset classes (public/private/markets/sectors) so that a mistake does not result in catastrophic loss.
15. **Upskill with AI:** Proactively use AI tools to increase productivity by 50-100%; the job market for new analysts will shift from learning skills to teaching skills or adding unique value machines cannot provide.
16. **Journal and Learn:** Maintain a practice of journaling mistakes and successes; your personal skill set is more valuable than capital, and compounding your character/knowledge beats compounding money alone.

Full Transcript

It's our great pleasure to welcome to the show someone I've been looking forward to chatting for quite a while now a man who's saying the author of the curious mind. Amen. Thanks for joining us Thank You Kevin longtime listener first-time caller Now I just want to get it off the the right off the bat We're recording this a little earlier than usual. This is gonna be We're recording it at the end of August and we're gonna be putting it out in the middle of September. So if we talk about things that are

Not quite up to date just you'll understand why but you Have quite a great background in terms of your career and it's very very All over the place and very illustrious and when I was like listening to you go on about the different places you worked I thought oh my goodness like he this is the real cat meow of jobs that you've had did you No, you always wanted to be in finance. Like, did you have a plan to do this? Like, how did how did we get to this point? It's a funny story. It's a long story, but I'll give you the super short version. I was an immigrant kid born in Pakistan, lived there, came over to the US, luckily got into a place called Northwestern. I wanted to study computer science. My dad was like.

I don't know what computers are son, but how about electrical engineering? We kind of agreed to computer engineering and then as the years went by I convinced him computer science was the way to go. And then sort of three years through the degree of computer science I was like, shit actually, I don't like computer science, it's a little bit boring. Actually what I love is economics. So I got a little side minor thing in economics and I graduated in 99. Or I was going to graduate at 99 and I was like, oh, wow, love economics. What can I do with this? And all the big banks used to come to Northwestern to interview. I ended up getting a job at Lehman Brothers. And then when you join a firm like Lehman, as you know, they've taken a bunch of people into their start program, sales and trading program, and you go and interview with all the different desks. And the group that I liked was the credit derivatives desk or what was then called the CDO desk, collateralized debt obligation.

Wow. There I was in the collateralized debt obligations desk in the year 1999 in New York City and three World Financial Center. That's how it began. 1989 or 99? 99. OK, fair enough. So you had a ringside seat for what is about to come. Yeah. So super lucky to be sitting there right on the ground floor when we were building all of these CDOs and all of a sudden I could see our business boom. And there we were doing synthetic CDOs. I never went over the mortgage kind so you can't blame me for blowing up the world. I only did the credit kind. And slowly I moved over the trading desk at Lehman and then one day Goldman came calling in 2006, hey, we hear that you're doing good things. Would you like to come over to Goldman? And so I was very lucky.

The story of my life. That was a great move buddy. That was probably the move of your career. Exactly. And there's a funny story there too. I had wanted to move to Goldman many times and I tried to interview with them in 2001. They denied me after the first interview. Tried to go there in 2003. They denied me after the first interview. Okay, this time you guys are calling me. So this is great news. Yes, after, you know, you have to do, Goldman has this process of you have to interview with 25 people. And after two, three months of interviewing, they hired me in April 2006. Okay. So can you tell people about what a CDO is? And, you know, no, no, I think a lot of people would be interested. Like a lot of people might know and they're kind of feel like they, they're, you know, aware, but why don't you just go over it? And then we'll talk a little bit about the, the meltdown of the financial system.

So the best way to think about a CDO I guess and I'm trying to go back in history right now since I've tried not to think about this ever since I left that job So I will after you the therapy I will try to deal with this Basically in a typical CDO the first thing to know is you have two boxes one box with assets one box with liabilities so say in the credit kind that we were doing your assets were leverage loans, loans to market large companies, sponsored by companies, and then you would issue liabilities. The liabilities you would issue would be, say, 70, 75% triple A rated Moody's in S&P. You could have some double A, single A, triple B, double B inequity. So what you've done is you've transformed, and this was a very old Drexel-Michael

Milken technology, you've transformed what were a pool of single B or double B rated.

Leverage loans into something that is 70 75% triple A rated now because because they get the cash flows at the beginning and so it's like right so it's a Rearranged in terms of cash flows. I didn't realize that Drexel make you know that milken was part of that But what was what's the origin story there? The origin story there is the origin story there is and I don't know if if milken exactly did any of these, but all the people that worked with Milken and Drexel then went on to other shops like Solomon and others. And the mortgage back security, which is also just a form of a CDO, you're just slicing up cash flows, right? Any of these mortgage Fannie Freddie, they're all just all of those securities just slicing up a bunch of cash flows, they're over collateralizing the triple A's. And then there's a leveraged equity bit at the bottom.

that gets it residual or excess cash flow. And because of that over-collateralization, you've done sort of regulatory arbitrage where you had 100 worth of single B loans, nobody could buy that, weren't easily tradable, or in the case of mortgage bonds, nobody wanted a single household exposure. But you've arbitraged or you've transformed this unownable piece of security or securities into something any any guy can go take those trip delays and say yes Moody's and S&P have blessed them. I can get good regulatory capital against these assets. Let's sell these to the banks insurance companies. Let's go sell this middle part to somebody else. I'm asset manager and let's go sell the bottom two family offices and equities. So you've taken security which it was really hard for most people to buy and you've turned it into a much more Standardized piece of paper right and that was originally thought of from the guys who worked with milken is what you're saying That was the that concept was was born out of that crew Okay, so you're there at Lehman you luckily move over to Goldman and now you're a Goldman you have a ringside seat for what is the global Financial crisis and not only that you're in the you know Yes, you're not in the area that blows up the world, but you're pretty close. Um, so tell us, you know, what that was like, what you saw there. I'd love to hear any stories or anecdotes that you could share with us. Sure. So, um, here I go. I find myself at Goldman in 06 and I am on the 50th floor of one near Plaza,

which was the old original, um, Goldman had two buildings. One was a Broad Street building, which was really historically old. And then when they had overflown that building, they were in one New York Plaza, right by the train station South Seaport. And so there we are. And I'm sitting right outside a guy's office. It was pretty well known. Harvey Schwartz, now the CEO of Carlisle and Don Mullen, now the founder of the firm called Pre-Jin.

I'm still trying to do my CDO bit. I've sort of graduated from cash flow CDOs into synthetic CDOs and Goldman was looking for people. So there we were making these things. And you can kind of feel that the ground is starting to shake. You know, in 0.607 you could already feel like credit quality, not what it used to be. everybody's pushing the envelope, all these new things are being created. I was seeing synthetic CDO squared and synthetic CDO cubes being created. So I was like, hmm, probably not gonna, probably not gonna end well. So what do we do here? Luckily, I managed to, there was a new team being created by a famous guy called Alan Brazil. And if you Google Alan Brazil, Goldman Sachs, you'll find out he ran quite an interesting business at Goldman. So I joined him and our job then became from 0607 onwards to basically go to the firm's biggest clients, which were hedge funds at that time, and take the best ideas. So the model being Usually, when you call a hedge fund, when you say you call Oak Tree, you're usually a credit sales guy calling a credit hedge fund. If you're a macro sales guy calling a macro hedge fund. But the Goldman idea was, well, the best idea is right now, the world is becoming correlated in 1708, all the trades were traded, all things were trading as one. So we want to show our clients the most interesting trades, the most asymmetric trades. And as you know, one of the things that a lot of hedge funds benefited from at the time, people like Paulson, were short the mortgage trade or short CDS trade, right? So we helped client get that trade on, whether the short MBS trade or the short CNBS trade or the short credit trade. And so my group's job was to take the best ideas that we had on the Goldman trading floor, whether they came from credit rates, FX commodities, equities, and say, go to our top clients and say, we got this idea for you. And like it's like new thing at sales. Your job shouldn't be to like just be selling whatever it is and clipping that offer. You want to you want to be innovative, you know, Goldman, I think has always been good at sort of trying to be value add.

And so our job was, hey, this is the best idea we have. This is what you should do. Or hey, we know you have this risk on on your books. You're very long credit. This is how you can hedge some of that exposure.

So I didn't realize this. So Goldman realized that there was, in essence, the market was too segmented in that everyone just spoke to their own silo and that there was a value added by taking a bigger picture and crossing over asset classes and trying to sell clients on a bigger picture trade. And no one had done this before? I don't think anybody had done it before. Most hedge funds were used to covered by one guy who only spoke the language or rates language. Because by the way, one other thing you should know about Goldman, it's a super competitive place also internally. So if you're calling a hedge fund again, let's just use Oak tree because everybody's heard of them. There might be five different people from Goldman calling the same hedge fund. There might be a rates salesperson FX salesperson equity.

And so you're all competing for the same thing. And the reason I'm telling you this is at least to the next part of the story, but, um, everybody would be trying to pitch something. And so you, as a salesperson, uh, would have to have, you know, better ideas than the other guy calling, cause you're not just competing against soft chin or credit Suisse. You're competing against your own. Okay. So tell us, tell us about the, cause first of all, I'm fascinated. And I think that a lot of kudos. You know go owed to Goldman for having the guts to do that and to be able to withstand the internal politics Because as you say you're absolutely correct that that is the problem These sales guys are usually very protective of their clients and don't want to let another sales guy into their client into their to talk to their client So tell me about how that works because you guys come up with all these trades So you're in essence going around pitching everyone Oh, look, this risk is way underpriced, meaning it's trading too rich. You can short it. And so you guys are in essence the ones that are telling people to put on the big short. Yeah. So one thing you should know about firms like Goldman, there's three types of people at these firms. Most people have heard of traders, everybody's heard of salespeople. One thing that Goldman figured out a long time ago was something called strats. And so strats are strategists.

these were like the geeks like me. And so I always laugh about that movie that's seen with Ryan Gosling in the movie The Big Short. Hey, have you seen my quant? So I was at quant, right? And so that was my job. And so my job was to find like how to make things work and how to come up with big trades. And I tell the strat story also, because for every flashy sales guy, there was somebody behind the scene who was coming up with the right trade. to be like, hey, sales guy, we should take this trade. And so the group I was in, we were sales tracts. And so our job was to feed the salespeople the best ideas in the firm. And so later I had the more our team got paid. All right. So so walk us through any stories or tell us how that played out in the next year or two as it all came on glued. I'd love to hear any war stories you can share. Yeah. So there was a lot that was happening. Let's just say, I mean, I remember doing trades where things were really coming unhinged in the sovereigns, you might remember the pigs were or something, you know, the Europe was blowing up, basically, in Portugal, Greece, Spain, and people got that trade put on. And then people were worried about Germany going down. I even remember panic got so high that people were buying a CDS protection on US at 10 basis points and seeing a trade to 30 basis points and 40 basis points and so I guess what you know and then on the other hand I was sitting next to another sales guy who was talking to some of the biggest guys who had the credit in the mortgage trade on and unwinding those guys or AIG and some of those transactions things that I can't go into given things that I've signed but but but sitting there made you made you realize oh my god like the world's a super complicated place and like it's amazing that I get to sit in the middle of it and it was also amazing to go from you know a guy who was deep in the world of credit structuring and just making these asset liability things to being like oh my god all these macro things connect and what's happening here will impact here if the guy has a credit trade on what can you do to hedge it using Nikkei dividend swaps or print put options? Like all of these sort of things connect in an interesting way. And even the smartest people in the world don't see that. Okay. So the core of the world became more clear as you sat here on the front row of the world falling apart. Yeah, that became clear. And I think the other thing that became clear was because I left that job, right? I left that job at 09. I stayed with Goldman, but I asked to be moved from Goldman, New York from trading floor.

to covering family offices because what I saw there was sometimes hedge funds who work with other people's money. Firstly, it's OPM. Secondly, hedge funds come and go. Many did go out of business. I was also part of that team that was basically saying, hey, hedge fund, you need to post more margin. And if you don't, we're going to have to wind you down as your prime broker. And so you see these people who are betting with other people's money, often they got taken out. And so in 0809, I sort of had the realization Hey man, I need to work with people whose money it is because oftentimes I'd be talking to my clients in 0809 and they're like funds shutting down. I'm like, are you guys being redeemed? They're like, yeah, like where's the money going? It's going back to the European family officers who gave us the money 10 years ago. In the end, you got to follow the money. And I don't know if you were in New York in 0809, but New York became quite a depressing place. And we were all talking about, you know, do we need guns and a canoe to get out of here when the pitchforks come for us because Things were pretty bad in New York. If you were going back, you guys were doing God's work though. Okay. So, so you asked to go, you know, work with the family office. And so that must have been quite a change in terms of time frames. Like you go from guys worrying about next month, the, you know, markings to people thinking about next year or maybe next decade walk. Tell me, you know, what were your biggest surprises and how did that work out as you moved?

for it to the family office side of Goldman Sachs. Yeah. So I think what you said is a big idea that we could double click on into which is, you know, this whole idea of timeframe because families whose money it is or anybody whose money it is can sort of think. And if you're a family and you want to be around in 10 or 50 or 100 years time, then you act differently versus, hey, if you're just intermediary playing with somebody else's money and or by the way, you're in a tight leash, right? I'm sure you and I have both heard the stories of friends who can't stand to underperform for three or six months because they know they'll get redeemed. And so I wanted to find this who didn't need to think about redemption, who could think about big ideas. Personally, I felt like my edge was not in thinking about what's going to happen next week or next month, but actually what could happen in two, three years. And by the way, the more I sort of looked at, you know, being a kid who's fascinated with money, the more you look at these big lists, like

the richest people in the world, you're like, Well, this guy didn't make money overnight. He compounded, right? So you want to be with people who have the ability and capacity to compound for 30, 40 years and not just day trade them their way into success. That's not how success is. I was like, well, wouldn't it be cool to hang out with some of the richest people in the world and work with them and trade with them and help them? Because this guy's figured out a way to be worth five or 10 billion.

Obviously, he probably has a lot more to teach me than some hedge fund analysts who just blew up his fund. Right? Right. Not every was up. There's many successful guys. But and by the way, then the other other problem I've always had personally, and this is the personal problem, which is I get bored every five to six years. So I have to change jobs every five years. Otherwise, I just feel like you're stagnating. Okay. So you're there, you work for five years in Goldman Sachs private clients or the high network individuals or whatever division that was eventually you go somewhere else. Where do you go from there? Yeah, so I was there from 2009 2014 made MD along the way, 2011, 2012. And then in 14, one of my clients hires me. Famous guy now probably was well less well known than a guy called Patrick Rahi.

Altis Telecom. He's known for having a lot of debt. He also owns Sotheby's. An interesting colorful guy, right? So it was my dream to work with one of these guys who had gone from being worth nothing to being worth five or six or seven billion. I don't know what he was worth at the top. And there he was. And so he gave us a bunch of money. He said, go at it. Manage this money, compound it, grow it. And being next to a guy who's gone from being worth nothing to being worth five or six billion and who gives you a bunch of money and says make it grow. Now there I was a guy who would work on mostly the sales side his whole life and now he's been given a bunch of money. Kind of a dangerous thing and so I'm very thankful to Patrick that he gave us the opportunity and we could do anything and when you can do anything, what do you even do? So our job was to do equities and credit and real estate and distressed. It was a bunch of things. I enjoyed it a bunch.

there were things that went wrong in that relationship, which there's no need to go into. And so I said, okay, well, what do I like? I like the probably I like the buy side more. There's no point going to the sell side. I've seen enough of the sell side. And so I was lucky, a firm called Newburger Berman found me and I joined them. And I became the global head of their family off the strategy. So my job was to What do we do with this client base, the richest people in the world? How do we get New Burger in front of them? And then my job was to work directly with a bunch of these clients. I'm not mistaken. I think I have a book like it's so far so good and or something of that nature. And it's about the New Burger, Burgam story. I got this right. The first 94 years in autobiography of the Wall Street legend Roy Newburger. Is that the same for me? I got it right. All right.

So you're there you're doing that and then now eventually you you've recently Left there and you're now writing for yourself. Why don't you tell us about the curious mind what you're doing today? So I was trying to follow the Kevin Muir life journey I'm a little bit slower and so I just took me a little bit longer I said hey if Kevin can do it and I should try No, I just kind of got to a place where the, the institutional constraints were boring. You know, there's things you can't, you can't say, trades you can't do. Um, it, it didn't seem as fun anymore. And I'm 49 now. I'm going to turn 50 into the probably midlife crisis happening somewhere there. And so at least it's just starting to get some stack instead of a blonde and a Ferrari. Exactly. Exactly. Funny you say that.

When I left Newburger in July, I've started writing. And so the idea behind, you know, I sort of had three loves. One love is investment capital markets, that's sort of one big bucket. The other is, like I said, at the beginning, I was a computer science major. I care about technology. I think it's important. And three, you know, once I had kids and I have two now, 13 and 15, two girls, I care about human potential. human agency. And so I wanted to have a place where I could talk about all of those things. And so that is what the curiousmind.org is a place where I think about talk about all of those things, then turned into a research letter, it's then turned into something super private called the brain trust. But that's what I'm investigating. I'm investigating the intersection of those three places, markets, technology and people. Okay.

So let's get into it. Let's, um, let's start with Marcus technology and people. I'm, um, let's, uh, let me think about where we should go first. I guess, you know, let's keep it big picture because one of the things that I think too often in life is that everyone wants to know where the next tick is going to be in the next, you know, what they're going to say at this next Jackson hole or what the fed's going to do next meeting. And that's actually. You know, sure it's interesting, but the real big money is made in the bigger calls, right? So let's let's zoom out and let's first examine where do you think the opportunities lie? In terms of the current market structure where you have all these pod shops that are forced to mark to market every month and are chasing returns. And not only that, we have this insane momentum occurring and all of these different aspects where the world has become flatter, meaning that there's all sorts of technology in the old days with us on the trading desk. We actually had an edge with being on a trading desk and now you get on Twitter and anyone can get all the information that we had back then. So stepping back, where do the opportunities lie in terms of investing from your perspective? Yeah, I think firstly, great question.

which leads to an even bigger question behind that, what are you solving for? Because we could say, what's the opportunity market? I would say, well, what do you want out of your money? Some people are like, well, actually, this is true. A lot of people are in the market just to be entertained. They want to be entertained, they want to learn and putting their money. Some people are there purely as, and I see this with some large families. their goal is just like, I need to leave more money to my kids in 20 years time. And what happens between now and 20 years is irrelevant as long as I'm on that curve of getting there, right? So one bigger thing to just think about is what is the point of money? Because I think sometimes when you're in the markets all the time, and I'm guilty of this too, we sort of are looking like I got to trade, I got to make money. But like, hey, dude, like, what do you what is the goal? Because money money is not goal in and of itself, right? I'm sure if you think But your happiest memories, they have nothing to do with money. And how money might have bought you some of those things, but they have nothing to do with money. So I always say, like, make sure that you're sort of putting money as a tool that allows you to accomplish your goals, not something that is like, hey, that's all I think about every single day. I don't know your happiest memories. Yes, some of

my happiest memories are with my family and stuff. But right below that is selling the high in the, you know.

So I'm not sure I might be too much of a DJ and because too often my non-family happiest memories are some trade I nailed. But okay, I hear you for a lot of people that is not what their, their goal is. So when you're looking at it, do you agree though that the world has become faster, more short-term oriented and that in itself, is an opportunity for people that aren't constrained by that same sort of, um, okay. Nobody can think long-term anymore. Nobody can hold things for any length of time anymore. Cause as we discussed a few minutes ago, everybody's on this three month, if not six month treadmill. And if you're a pot shop, your treadmill is a lot shorter. I was going to say three, six months. That's given them a lot of chance because it feels like a lot of times it's two months tops. It's over. Right. Exactly. And so most people, most people.

are in the end just chasing momentum. And I think that's if you look at this market, where you have these parabolic rallies, you have this flash crashes, because when it's working, we all have to chase it because our LP is going to be judging us every three months, six months on performance. And if we weren't the best, somebody else did better, the money will move. So there is no staying power anymore. If you talk to most GPs, they're like, dude, my LP is so fickle, I wish I had better LPs, or the structure is just set up to just give their LPs weekly or quarterly or monthly liquidity. And so they just can't keep the money. And so there's this whole structure that's broken down. And I think partly to do with societal trust, partly to do with just the nature of finance, partly to do with information is just so easily available, that all of that thinking is gone. And that's partly broken capitalism, because we're all just teaching and chasing momentum. Right. Can I interrupt there actually, because I had this theory, and I wrote about this back in 2014, and I called it A series of rolling mini bubbles. Yeah, and what I did was I noticed and I noticed this that there was these Bubbles and they just seemed to they were Violent and they and they took long they didn't take long They were up and down in a year or two years time and in the past it felt like the bubbles were much longer and bigger and then I noticed these these kind of little mini bubbles that I that I was starting to notice is your and I've never like people have asked me why this has occurred and I've always struggled

with this part of the answer. I haven't had a good reason to explain it, but I think you just did a better job than I've ever done. Do you think it's the structure of the way that the money management industry has arranged itself has forced these guys to actually chase momentum?

Well, I think the structures are definitely, you know, having seen what we've built, they're designed to give clients uses ETF, gives clients during the day liquidity, right? We used to have a world in which you made a commitment, you're in this fund, you probably wouldn't know what it was worth until. every week or every on barons who check the weekly stock code. And now you're like, Oh, I'm down today. I got to get out. This is not working. Right? You made a motion that we feel fear and greed were monkeys in the end. And you know, having been in finance for so long, I've realized just how sad the monkey mind is. But I think to your specific point, yes, the structure of a lot of these things because of LP pressure have made have made them be much more transient. Okay.

Alright, so I interrupted you though. You continue so we have this situation where there's more and more momentum Where do the opportunities lie for somebody who is like aware of that and is able to fade it like The problem is that the momentum is so strong It feels so difficult to be on the other side and I guess you shouldn't be on the other side You should really just be going and trying to find the thing that everyone's forgetting about as opposed to trying to fade the momentum. Am I correct? Yeah, I think you know I wrote about this this week Which was this idea of the weirdness premium and I can go a lot of ways with that But one of those is just having a beginner's mind right if you look at let's take the AI bubble for a second Let's call it bubble. I'm sure a lot of your business would be like, yeah, it's definitely a bubble So, but, you know, when, when I don't get into a trade, when something goes up and something does well, I always ask myself, there's probably three things that happen. Did I not know about this trade? Did I not have time to diligence this trade? Or three, which I think is true for most of us is it didn't somehow align with my identity or what I thought I knew, you know, I remember looking at NVIDIA six years ago and thinking like, oh my god whatever 300 billion is too rich kuda yeah it has all of this but it doesn't really work it's too expensive already uh and i didn't even do the real work it was i was just like this looks wrong ai is a fake just

like the metaverse or all these other things this is another hype cycle i feel like we often too often get into our tribes that we're comfortable with and those tribes because of who we spend time with and who we talk to and what we read keep us in these filter bubbles and so one of the things I'm trying to break and I'm worried about this for for us and for our kids is that we need more cognitive diversity we need more weirdness in our life people who don't look like us but might take a different view we need more disagreement in our life we've kind of coddled ourselves to be like we just want to hang out with people like us who agree with us and share our views but like I think it's very important to have polite disagreement what's the art of that, right? And you could see with the Democrat, Republican, all the issues that are happening in our country are also reflected in our markets are also reflected in our trades. We're doing the comfortable trade, as opposed to what actually makes us uncomfortable. And sometimes sitting with a manager who's underperforming is also uncomfortable. So we've kind of placated ourselves to always do what's comfortable. I need to redeem. I need to do this. I need to do that. Like, bro, just maybe even though you think AI is a bubble, like, let's go do the work.

Don't read the negative AI stuff for a while. Go six months and only meet positive AI. Go move to San Francisco. Like what are you doing to convince yourself that you're wrong? Yeah, I see some of the greatest investors out there. One of the things that always surprises me is how much they seek out the other side. They go out and they say, I want to go. And even though every bone in my body tells me that this guy is wrong, I want to understand where they're coming from. Totally. And it just happened to me when I was working at the family office, we had this position on in this company, a Golar, and I was like, Oh, it's so good. It's 25, 30 stock is going to 60 or 70 met with this hedge fund in New York told me all these negative things. And I was just too tight to the I'm the bull on this. I understand better than you. And he was right about this entire thing. I just wouldn't take him seriously because I was, I was like, clearly.

I've done more work or my position is right. You know, you like you got to take people who don't agree with you seriously and actually just assume, you know, like the old saying, assume that you know nothing. Yeah. The other thing I I really struck me when you were talking there was you said

we need to have more polite disagreement in society. And I think that is also one of the problems in and I find this in Twitter and I've gotten off Twitter, but like you get on there and people view You know if you're short one of the stocks that they're long they feel like you're you know Coming to take over their village and you're about to crush them and one of the things that always my I always admire about the Chicago guys whenever I would interview a Chicago trader They were very much like that's what makes a market like they'd be like, okay You're long I'm short and I think that part of the reason that they are so comfortable with having people on the other side of the trade is because they saw them all every day in terms of their like the guys they were trading with where the guys opposite them in the pit so they you know they were they were fine with having different positionings and it really kind of I'm very disappointed how we've gone down this road whereas if you say something is overvalued people take it as an affront and that you're in essence like you know insulting them and no like I have a different opinion and not only that you should welcome different opinions and I always tell people I said the reality is that if we all agreed then there would be no trade you need someone on the other side of your trade so when I sit there and I come up with a trade and people tell me I'm wrong I'm like well that's great because actually that means that there's more people to agree with me when they change later hopefully and now I could be wrong as well but I just the thing that really makes me sad in our society is how that polite disagreement is completely vanished exactly Exactly, I think that is the biggest failure and I think one of the biggest risks to thinking because if you It just makes your portfolio very fragile because all you know is one one angle one approach a Your question your approach might be wrong be there's a lot of money You're probably leaving on the table. You might have a you an oil going to 100 cool man But maybe there's money to be made on being short a short oil or maybe this money be made in AI at the same time or in Korea There's lots of ways to make money with people who get religious and like, you know, which is why I try never to talk about my positions or my trades because then it ties you to position. You've automatically said, this is me. And which is why I never write about what I'm doing because then you know, psychologically, you get married to a position. It is true. And if you look at Stanley Druckenmiller, when he's talking about his positions, often he'll say, I'm telling you this today, but it could change tomorrow.

and he does it and he's doing it for everyone else but he's also doing it for himself because what he's trying to do is he's trying to maintain the ability to be intellectually flexible and to move his position not only that he knows that it's going to change and I'm sure you've seen traded with I'm sure some of the greatest traders out there you know how intellectually flexible they are in terms of the best traders out there exactly it's like you know the book title being right versus making money Your job, I think is just to take the line as Dennis Garkman used to say, from bottom left to top right. It's not to have a fucking view. Your job is bottom left to top right. And I remind myself that you don't need to have a view. Just do that. So we're talking about this is one aspect of great traders and how they make money. You know, you've been around a lot of different traders, a lot of different investors. What are some of the other things that have surprised you about what traits they might have in common. I think if you look at, you know, a few years ago, I went and looked at some of the richest families in the world, right? Because hopefully we can all be fascinated with markets and be DJing and all of that. But we want, we're doing this for our family, our kids, most of us. They're pretty comfortable, right? We're not doing this to just put food on the table on a daily basis. So this is to say, We think about legacy, we think about the impact of our money on other people, we think about the charitable causes we can support. Which means, again, you're back to thinking long term and thinking, if I have X dollars today, how can I create a machine, you know, take a Ray Dalio idea of having two Xs of three Xs of four X dollars. So what is the portfolio I need to construct? And what are the things that could destroy my portfolio? So not some solid idea. How do I make myself anti fragile? So what I've sort of learned from all of these people is make sure firstly, you don't blow up. Okay, how are you going to blow up? B, know clearly what is the goal you're solving for and hopefully it's more than just entertainment. You're trying to get to x number and x x point. Okay, great. Three, simplicity. A lot of you know, what I see go wrong with a lot of families is they have super complicated processes, ruptures, risks, nobody's tracking it and Stuff disappears after one generation, two generations, three generations all gone. And so, you know, you need to know what you're solving for, figure out what's going to kill you and make sure it doesn't kill you. Three, keep your stuff simple. Even, you know, like imagine explaining your investments. Imagine, and this is morbid, but imagine you pass away tomorrow and your kid or your wife has

to look at the portfolio. Are they going to know what what's water? Which asset is where and is attached protected inheritance tax? Again, basic stuff, but these are the things you learn from people because they're not thinking uh jackson hall they're thinking like i gotta be better in five or ten or 20 years time and then and then the other thing is they are spread across a bunch of things you know obviously a billionaire had one thing that went really well and they probably held it for 50 years or um and it was a single investment but most people if you that's not gonna happen for most people right for most people what you really want is you want to figure out how you're going to harvest a lot of different risk premiums. So some people, they only trade commodities and that's fine. But what I'm saying is, if you're good at public markets, good, but go find a buddy who's really good at private markets and figure out how he's doing what he's doing. A, it'll give you cognitive diversity. B, it'll feed your curiosity and it'll help you. Okay, I'm along this public company here. What are they doing in private markets that might come and kill this company? Three, there are interesting opportunities everywhere. So just because you've done this segment of the public market your whole life.

don't think that you're limited to that, right? And most families, if you look at the biographies, you look at people like Rockefeller, Carnegie Mellon, it doesn't feel like technology now because it feels boring. But they were all doing some high tech stuff. Rockefeller figured out some high tech stuff about how to be vertically integrated, big melon figured out steel banking. So all of these people we're operating at the cutting edge of the technology at the time. We don't think of canals or hillways roads as technology, but they were the hot technology at the time. And so when we downplay technology or because, you know, the human mind likes to play mean reversion and I'm down with that. There's money we play in mean reversion, but the big money is played on the big themes, the big technology and writing them for little one of the things that you've highlighted there is allocation to different asset classes. And I think that Too often you're right. We get stuck in our in our different silos I'd love to kind of understand How if you're a large family and you're thinking about how to allocate money how that's moving around and and specifically one of the things that I I know I talked to one of my buddies that's been around he's very smart guy and he always says to me Okay, but we know the the

consultants are just starting to get a hold of that trade and that when that trade the consultants are just starting and and he says it's going to be years for them to move it around and I think that we as traders sit around as you know rightfully say Jackson Hole thinking about the next 10 minutes not understanding that some of these trends are extremely long and you have highlighted private equity and private credit And there's no doubt that money has been flowing into there. But what do you explain to people in terms of how long it takes for that money to move around? And then specifically highlight where you think money might be headed in the big picture asset classes in the years to come. Yeah. So I think a lot of good points in that statement, Kevin. Firstly, you know, if you Our investing five or ten billion if you're fiduciary a pension insurance company sovereign wealth fund family office Jackson Hole irrelevant because what are you gonna do about it? You're not gonna move ten billion five billion just because of some statement or what the Fed did like you can't and you won't and so therefore it is irrelevant what matters is okay step one What's my goal if your family office? Maybe your goal is CPI plus six. Okay, firstly people are surprised when I say that. What do you mean CPI plus six?

They want to make real return. They want to beat inflation because they want to be richer in the future in real terms and then by how much? Some are as simple as CPI plus three, some are CPI plus six. Then we started getting more nuanced, right? Firstly, did this family make money? And let's just talk about family offices because I know that segment better than other segments is did they make money? Are they first generation versus third generation? First generation, totally different behavior. They made the money. They know how to handle it. If they lost it, they could probably make it again. Third generation, somebody who inherited from grandpa is really fucking scared because if they lost it, they don't really know how to make it back. And there'll be a lot of people pissed off at them because hey, dude, what the hell and their lifestyle is going to be impacted. So totally different risk appetite. Then what industry did they make their money in? If they made their money in finance, they're probably quite comfortable with markets if they made their money in shipping.

and they probably are uncomfortable with markets and yeah they sold their shipping company but now they're like oh my god capital markets and

trades how do I do this which probably means that when they build the team around them they probably don't pay them finance wages they pay them shipping container wages which is to say that they have probably lower quality people working there than finance people right so just quickly because you know when I first got into the family office I'm like oh they're going to look like hedge funds it's going to be a bunch of smart guys just like the hedge fund guys I used to cover totally different setup because every rich dude is totally different from every other rich dude because they all make totally different ways and so if you are a totally different individual you hire a totally different team that have totally different experience you end up with totally different portfolios so we used to cover some of the richest people in Europe and a guy worth 50 billion at his peak at his entire family office was in cash Why? Because he had a steel company that would keep doing the rights offering as the price of steel was falling and to buy those rights offering the family officers needed to sit in cash. We had other people who were 90% private funds, co-investments, direct deals because they just needed to make 15% per annum and the only way to do that was doing direct deals. Both the rich families, both first or second generation, totally different way of seeing the world.

So those are a bunch of generalizations on even these people are quite different. Let's go to your, I think let's go to your last question, which is to say, what do we do about all of this, right? Like where are things headed? I think one thing that it's clear, look, I was very lucky to join finance in 99. We had a lot more boom that happened, whether it was interest rates or new technologies being created. And, but by the way, a lot of money the big money in the last few years has not been made on Wall Street. It's been made in Silicon Valley. That's where the big money, all the Wall Street guys look around and feel poor compared to much billions of dollars. So firstly, we should know that the game is moved. If you thought you were just moving pieces of paper around and making money, those guys are moving bits around. So I think when you look at the world, firstly, you have to say, and by the way, this is one of the reasons I left finance, which is to say, the world is changing massively and it's changed a lot since I've been in it but I feel like right now it's a much bigger change than the 27 years that I've been in finance since 99. So one thing is just to like stop the music for a little bit look around like am I just pretending like nothing has changed in the world

because you got to take things like AI quite seriously. So you say the world has changed more in the last year or two than any time in your 27 year career.

Is that specifically technology you're talking like the AI, the AI world? I would say it has changed. And I can see it changing much faster from here. OK, not. You might say, well, actually, functionally, isn't it the same thing that I was doing two years ago? I say, well, I hope that you're not doing things exactly you were doing two years ago. I hope you're using these tools a lot more. But I can see because of the way these tools are now being integrated. the world is going to look super different in five years time and so that change is coming and most people are not appreciating it because a human mind doesn't understand exponentials and human mind generally believes in mean reversion things will generally be because but i fundamentally feel which is why i left my job because i feel like the world is going to change in time and i gotta just spend all my time thinking about that and helping the world think about those changes Okay, explain to me how you think the world is going to change. Like, I understand you're saying that we're at a monumental point in the evolution of our society and that this is going to be one of those periods like the railroad coming that is going to change. But what do you think it looks like in five years time? And how, you know, like, give us some color on those changes if you can. So, you know, simple things like how In the old days, you would be, okay, I need to read a lot of stuff. I need to read the 10Ks. I need to build the models myself. I need to be on the conference call. I need to suck in all that data. All that stuff can happen in a second now. I've had many friends who built these tools. I've built these tools who can digest all of that information and give you the, you had to ingest the information and then put your judgment to it to come up with a question. A lot of those ingestion, analyzing, building, can be done in a second. So therefore the question becomes, what is the human form? What do I know that a machine cannot know and will not know? Is it judgment? Is it character? Is it curiosity? Is it asking a better question? So I think we need to prepare for a world in which, because, you know, all of us did jobs that were a lot of different things. 90% of that job can now be done by a machine.

you have to figure out and everybody's job is different. So that's why I'm not going to specifics. What is going to be your special edge that a machine will want? Because in the capitalist system, if they can have a machine that works 24, 7, 7 days a week and can do exactly what you do, it will do that. Right. And I've tried to for the last three years with my kids and myself become a Uber user of these tools, cloud code, cloud design, all of that. And I've seen the value I get. for 20 pounds a month, I'm getting like thousands of dollars worth of value, something that I would pay somebody for as an individual, sitting with me, I'd probably pay them 100 grand, 200,000 to do that job. So what you're seeing is, A, productivity will massively go up, B, and we saw this again at my prior firm, we don't need to hire as many young people, right? And the reason, again, I'm being general here is that there's so many ways you can go down, it's gonna impact and it's already impacting young people being hired into the industry.

Right. So we're going to have this weak link where my class when I joined Lehman was they took in 15 new analysts or 90 new analysts. Why would I hire an analyst right now? Like I can have them. I can have the machine do what I needed to do. So what value are you bringing? So if you're a young person, you show up in the industry, you either better know how to use these tools better than me and teach me something or figure out how to add value because I'm not paying for you to just come and learn. that that world is gone now right there's a lot more pressure from shareholders to get something going and if i can get the machine to do it and the machine can operate already at a 22 or 25 year old level and they're going to get the 29 year old level and the 30 year olds level and so you need to figure out um but it's like you know what happened in chess um man machine together can beat the machine and can beat man and so we need to figure out and again i'm spending a lot more time on this which is like How do I become better at these tools, which is the only way to stay up to speed? You asked a specific question, which is like, I'm just asking specific questions to try to get you to explain what you're thinking. So whatever gets us there is great. I didn't realize this. I'm not up to speed on chess. You're saying that that man versus machine man loses machine man and machine together beat machine. Is that what you're saying? Yeah.

Oh, I didn't realize that. And that's true in most industries, right? Because machine can do a lot of the thinking. Man has a different role to play. I think we need to all think about, you know, some people say, well, the machine is never going to come for this job. And there's probably a lot of healthcare jobs where it will be fine. But the machines are going to come for all of it. And they have come for a lot of these jobs over the years. Most of us have been immune because they've been knowledge worker has been spared from it. But there's lots of other industries that have been taken away because of technology. I think they're coming for knowledge work. And even if your job is not at risk, don't think about it from a job risk point of view. Just think about it like, please use these tools. They will make you 50%, if not 100% more productive. I mean, you know, if you could, you're a solo guy, right? You might have more to people. No, I'm just me.

Yeah. So there's so many more things that I can do now through using these tools that I have not been able to do. So I just tell people look for whatever dollars a month, you can be twice as productive, go check it out. But this is going to permeate the industry and folks like Citrini have done a good job writing that memo. I think it was super memo. It got people super nervous at the beginning, but these things are feeding through. I've seen it across industries. It is now impacting how you hire people, how you train people. what you yourself can do, there's going to be more people to start businesses because it's much easier to start that. Got it. And so my question to you is that it's interesting to hear you say that, you know, they have this, this optimistic or not, or this excited view about AI and how it's going to change the world because the other, you know, earlier in this conversation, you said it's a bubble. So how do you reconcile it's a bubble and Just give us your thinking about AI in terms of changing the world versus AI as an investment. And I was half joking about AI being a bubble because that is a narrative. And to your point on what consultants, as long as the world keeps calling AI a bubble, I know we will climb the wall of worry. Remember the wall of worry?

things. And we had walls of worry for QE and we had walls of worry for so AI is another wall of worry. People are now like, Oh my God, all this hyper scalar capex is a waste of money. memory stocks are trading at five times earnings because we're going to find a way to work around them. So I've

seen this wall of worry in multiple different industries. This is another wall of worry. Great, you know, when when oil spiked right into our moves, I'm like, okay, we got a wall of worry. That was the high. So I think Just to go on a tangent for a second one of my angles on macro is More important than predicting an event is to know what everybody else is already betting on right and mostly Usually is better to fade the consensus But you got to know where where everybody is just and the same thing happens when companies announce earnings They the company might not be consensus, but you have to know Based on consensus, what was the whisper number? How is everybody positioned? And then the number is a number. You don't really need to know the number. You just need to know what everybody's positioning is. And then you play with the positioning. And that doesn't matter. But sorry to go back to what you were saying. Remind me. I was talking about the fact that you think it's a bubble. You think it's this revolutionary technology that's in fact going to change the world even more dramatically. You you have a very Uh like it's a very dramatic prediction you have about how how much it's going to change the world and yet at the same time you would think almost with that you know other guys that have that believe it's going to change the world that much would be all in on ai dan ives kind of tom lee style and and you're not that so where's the Where does your thinking break down and not break down, but where does the difference between you and Dan Ives in terms of your AI creation? So let's get into specifics. And this is not an investment device, but you know, right now my investment book is like 30, 40% AI related, 30% gold miners, 20% commodities, coal, metal, things like that. And then a bunch of other value bets, which is to say I'm invested in AI.

and where you need to be invested in that space changes over time. And so you need to speak to the guys who are at the forefront of that and where the money is moving. But fundamentally with AI, let me simple stats, right? Where is the largest capex dollars in America being spent? Yeah. So the only capex dollars in America are being spent. Okay, so now you could say, now you could go into an argument while this capex and how they're expensing it and the data center life is only three years, not seven years. You can get all technical and we could go down the rabbit hole. But dude, all of GDP growth in America is coming from one thing. All capex is going into building one thing. So do you just want to call it a bubble and like, no, I'm

not even going to think about it and talk about it. I'm just going to call it a bubble. And that's it. I put it in the box and I'm going to go do my other thing. Like you could do that, but like.

there's a trillion dollars worth of money moving around don't you want to figure out how if you could make some money from it so and that's what i've tried to do and so then the question then becomes if you go do that work and of course with any capex you know you go read alistair naren's book the engine that moves market big historical book i'm sure you've read it too it's about all the technology bubbles from canals to roads to railways over time of course capex bubbles end up in over investment and of course they end up in and that's fine But as Soros used to say, if you see a bubble forming, I don't think we're in the early innings anymore. And clearly it's more dangerous. You're sort of going up there, but you don't know if there's two or three years ahead. I think we still have two or three years ahead, but again, this is not a market prediction. So bottom line is go do the work, figure out where the angle is. But again, Don't be what I said at the beginning, which is like, get married to one idea and said, my whole portfolio is going to be in one trade. There's money to be made in gold miners too. And there's money to be made in coal miners and all sorts of other areas. So build yourself a portfolio that is anti-fraiser. So if you get it wrong, you're not going to blow up. And then also don't just be in public markets. Most people in public is easiest, but there's capital to be made in privates also. Got it. OK.

We're getting towards the end here. In terms of, like, asking you questions, if you were on the other side of the interview podium here, what would you have asked yourself that I've missed? Like, what is the big question that, you know, that we haven't spoken about yet? I think the question that I thought about in my job the whole time, and I still think about now, And especially for the future in my kids is what is your edge? Okay. What's your edge? You know, as a father, as husband, as an investor, as a writer, as a thinker, like what's your edge? Your wife is a hard partner. What's your edge? What's your edge, buddy? All these people are, you know, and even to that idea that I figured out in finance is you're always being measured.

like you might think you know a lot of people once they get a job they're like okay I got a job but like dude every day is an interview every day you're being measured every day you're being judged and so one advice I always get to young people is like just because you're doing a job where you just got hired without a big bonus but like you're always being measured and you're always being judged and you're being judged in rooms and I wrote an essay about this you know 20 to 2500 years of strategic wisdom what I learned from Closwitz and and others Can I just jump in here? You can take the boy out of Goldman, but you can't get Goldman out of the boy. Okay. So what is your edge? So what do people do and how do they figure out their edge and, you know, expand on that? So, you know, I've been between jobs.

many times we talked about the positive parts of my career where there are times that did not work out and and i had to be like dude what is wrong with me i remember being out of the job after being a goldman md and many firms wouldn't hire me and i was like dude but i was a goldman md like you're not hiring me what the hell and so look yeah i've been humbled uh i've had my ass kicked i've lost 20% of my net worth in one year. I've made a fair share of mistakes. So, um, you know, it's kind of what you say, all I have is 25 years of mistakes. 35 now, 35. I have to update it. All I have is 27 years of mistakes. I've been broken. Um, and so I, and so when exercise that I did, and it's different from everybody is just.

It's just to spend a lot of time journaling, right? And this is again, you know, getting philosophical on us. But I think a lot of times we don't spend like actually getting inside our head and being like, what am I thinking? What am I doing this for? What do I need? What am I good at? What should I be getting better at? What do I already know? And just turning yourself into a compounding machine like James Clear has this great analogy that I always tell young people, which is like, look, just figure out where you want to go. And then get closer to it on a daily basis. We all talk about compounding and investment in our capital. And Buffett talks about this. The most important asset is you, dude. You are the most important. Are you getting better as a person every single day? And if you get 1% better every single day, which doesn't seem hard for an individual to be 1% better every day,

you're 37X better after a year. That's compounding. You can compound yourself more than you can compound your portfolio.

Just compound yourself, right? We talk about Buffett, but we miss that part about Buffett. Okay, that is awesome. So listen, I'm going to spring a last question on you and over the years I've done a bunch of different ones. Sometimes it's music, sometimes it's something else. I think for you and your philosophical bent, I think that it's an easy one. I'm going to grab, I think it's Patrick O'Shaughnessy who does this one. So I'm going to steal it from him. And I apologize that I didn't prepare you for this, but I was wondering if you could share a story of some time in your career. of something that someone once did that was very kind to you, that was very important in terms of your development of your career. So I'm going to keep talking so that you have a chance to think about this. But in essence, what we're looking for is somebody that was helpful and kind to you along the way and a story that you could share with us. You could do that. Sure. I will get personal on this one.

and it's not directly to do with my career, but it has shaped my career. So, look, I got married at 25, divorced at 29 in New York, right? So there I am, divorced before most people get married. I'm sitting in New York City. 29 divorced, like, sitting with the checkers just happened to me. And I meet this girl who's now my wife, Nilu. and she's the lawyer at J.P. Morgan. She's a big breadwinner and cracking the whip on me and having me find my edge. But where she found me, I was in the abyss. I was a broken man and she picked me up and she changed me. And I was a very alpha, angry guy. And she fixed me. And then I fell again in 2010, 2011. I was trying to make NBA Goldman. I didn't make it. I fell into an abyss. 2016, I lost 20% of my net worth.

She was there. Never has she questioned me. Never has she pushed on me. She's always held my hand. She's always been supportive. She's brought me out of the abyss multiple times. I can't help but fall into the abyss and she always pulls me out of the abyss. So that is... That is a lovely answer. And unfortunately you've ruined this question for every single guy who goes in and has to answer in the future because they're going to, well, people will listen and go, geez, you know what? My wife never going to be able to live

up to your wife. So that is a lovely story. And so let's talk a little bit about your, about your sub stack, your letter. Tell us about it. Tell us what you're trying to accomplish, who it's for, how they can learn more about it. Thank you.

You know, no big sales pitch. It's like I said, I write something every week or so. It's at the intersection of markets, technology and people just trying to make sense of reality, trying to make sense of where I think we should be going. We should all be going. It's free for everybody. If you want the backup log, there's paid and for people who like things like 13D or what I learned this week, I started a research letter that is sort of off that ilk that will be launching in September. And then I have a super secret thing called the brain trust, which, you know, what I said earlier about the weirdness, premium or cognitive diversity, it is the gathering of 80 or 100 of people that are at the top of their game in different worlds and different geographies. And we all come together to share what is the super secret stuff because of the internet, everybody has stuff from Brock and ILLMS, but the real edge now, I think.

is what lives in people's heads. And so I spend a lot of time talking to people and getting that edge. I gotta write that down because that's the real edge is what lives in people's heads. Okay. You know, I mean, it's this has been a lovely, lovely time talking to you and you did not disappoint. Again, it's the curious mind on Substack is that go sign up. It's free. Everyone I highly recommend you do that. Thank you very much for your time. Thank you, Kevin. Pleasure.